

Downloads

Eke every byte out of your connection

Getting a faster internet connection always helps in boosting your download speeds, however for those of us on slower connections, there is still some hope.

Tweak your manager

We'll use Free Download Manager (FDM) as our example. Go to Options > Network, set Traffic usage mode to Heavy Mode. Increase the maximum number of connections and maximum number of connections per server. Also increase the maximum number of mirrors. Remember to tick the "Automatically search for mirror URLs" option. If you use Windows XP and Orbit Download manager, go to Tools > Preferences > Others and check the "Increase connection limit for Windows XP SP2".

Speed up torrents

Before you start downloading from the torrent network, check your maximum upload speed settings using online speed tests. Set your client's upload rate to about eighty per cent of your maximum upload speed. For µtorrent Go to Preferences > Bandwidth and change the "Global Upload Rate". Use queuing and connection settings to download not more than two torrents at a time.

Use browser extensions

Using browser extensions for downloads certainly reduces your time. As you don't have to crunch through a number of steps before you start your downloads. Use "Down Them All" for Firefox, its developers boast that it increases download speeds by 400 per cent, but we would not necessarily go that far. It

does a pretty good job though. Secondly, to grab any kind of media content currently playing in your browser use the "Download Helper" extension for Firefox to automatically catch it and download the file. Also try Download Master extension for Chrome. Activating Grab++ option in Orbit Download Manager also catches any viral video or flash files playing in your browser.

Download smartly

If you are downloading a file at a peak time when there is a lot of traffic, then you might get inconsistent or slow speeds, for this try downloading the file at different times of the day. The lower number of people on the network will mean better speeds for you. This is especially important for system admins in offices, who should set downloads for the night, when the bandwidth is freed up. Use queuing to ensure that no more than 2 downloads are running concurrently. Also clear your browser cache often, and help your PC get some much needed RAM back. **[E]**

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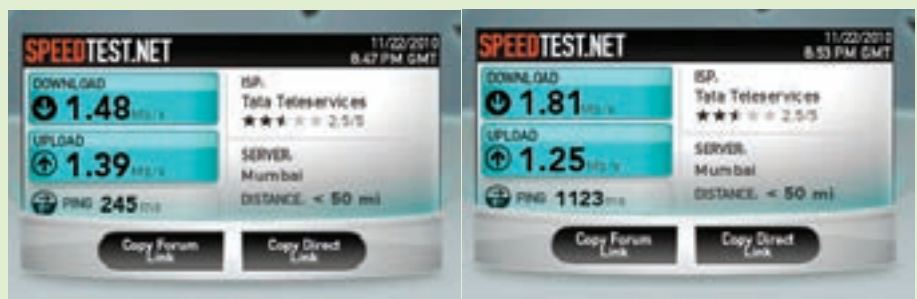
Uncap your surfing speeds

Uncap Windows

Windows allots 20 per cent of the bandwidth by default for various services like Windows update and spyware checks. The trick is fairly simple to get hold of the unused bandwidth. Here's what you do Go to Start > Run and type gpedit.msc. Go to Administrative templates > Networks > QoS Packet Scheduler. Click on Limit Reservable Bandwidth and check the enabled box and then change the Bandwidth limit from 20% to 0%. The screen shots above are the before and after results.

Limit bandwidth

To ensure that while browsing you get a fair amount of speed without



disrupting your downloads, capping your bandwidth comes in handy. Developed to control and monitor internet traffic the Netlimiter application limits your bandwidth. So for example let's say you want to download a software and play CS at the same time, but do not want your game to lag. The download speed you get is, say, 4 Mbps; limit it in a 2:2 ratio so that your movie download continues while you play CS without any breaks. This is what you do when you start your download, go to Netlimiter you'll see DL speed on top which would show

your current download speeds let's say for example you're getting 300kbps change this to 150. Once you have changed the value you can start enjoying your game while the download happens in the background.

SG TCP Optimiser

A free application to enhance your Internet speed, weighing a mere 419 KB the SG TCP optimizer takes into account only the necessary registry parameters and tweaks the overall speed making browsing lighter and faster than before. Just run the .exe file and follow the instructions. **[E]**